

Making the Move Easier

How to help a loved one settle in and feel at home quickly.

Moving into a care home is a big change. A little preparation, and plenty of familiar comforts, can make the transition far smoother for everyone.

Before the move

- Visit together beforehand so the home feels familiar on day one.
- Share your loved one's story with the team — routines, likes, dislikes, what makes them smile.
- Consider a short respite stay first, if that would help them decide.
- Label clothing and belongings clearly.

What to bring

- ✓ Comfortable, easy-to-wash clothing and sturdy footwear
- ✓ Favourite photos, a familiar blanket or cushion, treasured keepsakes
- ✓ A favourite chair or small piece of furniture, where space allows
- ✓ Toiletries and any glasses, hearing aids or mobility aids
- ✓ Medication and a list of prescriptions
- ✓ Books, music, hobbies and anything that brings comfort and joy

The first few weeks

- Visit regularly, but allow time for new routines to take root.
- Join in — a meal, an activity or an outing helps your loved one settle.
- Keep in touch with the named contact at the home and share any concerns early.
- Be patient and kind to yourself — mixed emotions are completely normal.

Settling in takes time — often a few weeks. Our teams keep families closely involved every step of the way, and you are always welcome to visit.

Staying involved

You remain a vital part of your loved one's life and care. Open visiting, family events and a team that picks up the phone mean you stay connected and reassured.